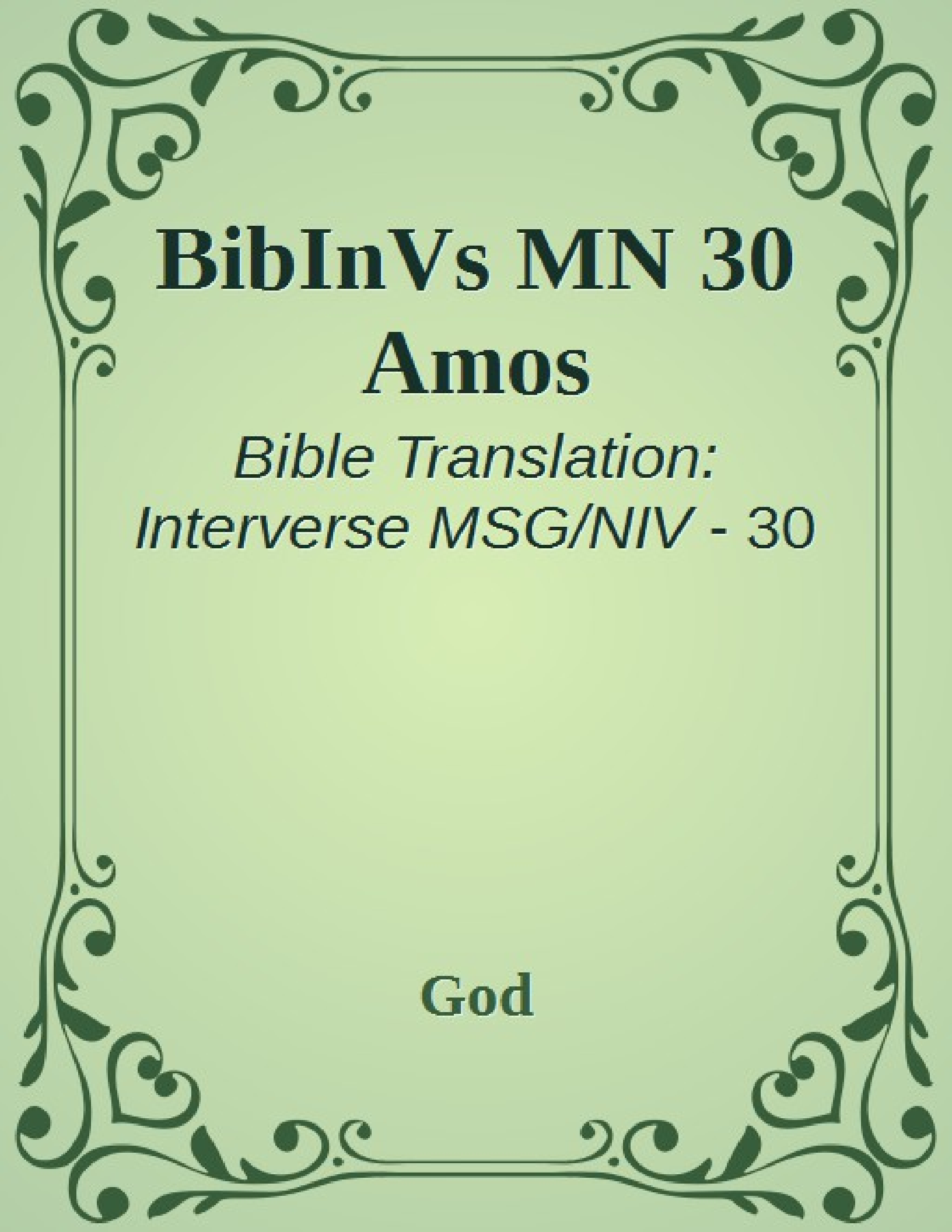


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 30

Amos

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 30*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Amos

Amos 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 The Message of Amos, one of the shepherds of Tekoa, that he received on behalf of Israel. It came to him in visions during the time that Uzziah was king of Judah and Jeroboam II son of Joash was king of Israel, two years before the big earthquake.
- 1 The words of Amos, one of the shepherds of Tekoa--what he saw concerning Israel two years before the earthquake, when Uzziah was king of Judah and Jeroboam son of Jehoash was king of Israel.
- 2 The Message: GOD roars from Zion, shouts from Jerusalem! The thunderclap voice withers the pastures tended by shepherds, shrivels Mount Carmel's proud peak.
- 2 He said: "The LORD roars from Zion and thunders from Jerusalem; the pastures of the shepherds dry up, and the top of Carmel withers."
- 3 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Damascus --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She pounded Gilead to a pulp, pounded her senseless with iron hammers and mauls.
- 3 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Damascus, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because she threshed Gilead with sledges having iron teeth,
- 4 For that, I'm setting the palace of Hazael on fire. I'm torching Ben-hadad's forts.
- 4 I will send fire upon the house of Hazael that will consume the fortresses of Ben-Hadad.
- 5 I'm going to smash the Damascus gates and banish the crime king who lives in Sin Valley, the vice boss who gives orders from Paradise Palace. The people of the land will be sent back to where they came from--to Kir." GOD's Decree.

- 5 I will break down the gate of Damascus; I will destroy the king who is in the Valley of Aven and the one who holds the scepter in Beth Eden. The people of Aram will go into exile to Kir," says the LORD.
- 6 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Gaza --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She deported whole towns and then sold the people to Edom.
- 6 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Gaza, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because she took captive whole communities and sold them to Edom,
- 7 For that, I'm burning down the walls of Gaza, burning up all her forts.
- 7 I will send fire upon the walls of Gaza that will consume her fortresses.
- 8 I'll banish the crime king from Ashdod, the vice boss from Ashkelon. I'll raise my fist against Ekron, and what's left of the Philistines will die." GOD's Decree.
- 8 I will destroy the king of Ashdod and the one who holds the scepter in Ashkelon. I will turn my hand against Ekron, till the last of the Philistines is dead," says the Sovereign LORD.
- 9 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Tyre --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She deported whole towns to Edom, breaking the treaty she had with her kin.
- 9 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Tyre, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because she sold whole communities of captives to Edom, disregarding a treaty of brotherhood,
- 10 For that, I'm burning down the walls of Tyre, burning up all her forts."
- 10 I will send fire upon the walls of Tyre that will consume her fortresses."
- 11 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Edom --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She hunts down her brother to murder him. She has no pity, she has no heart. Her anger rampages day and night. Her meanness never takes a timeout.
- 11 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Edom, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because he pursued his brother with a sword, stifling all compassion, because his anger raged continually and his fury flamed unchecked,
- 12 For that, I'm burning down her capital, Teman, burning up the forts of Bozrah."
- 12 I will send fire upon Teman that will consume the fortresses of Bozrah."

- 13 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Ammon --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She ripped open pregnant women in Gilead to get more land for herself.
- 13 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Ammon, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because he ripped open the pregnant women of Gilead in order to extend his borders,
- 14 For that, I'm burning down the walls of her capital, Rabbah, burning up her forts. Battle shouts! War whoops! with a tornado to finish things off!
- 14 I will set fire to the walls of Rabbah that will consume her fortresses amid war cries on the day of battle, amid violent winds on a stormy day.
- 15 The king has been carted off to exile, the king and his princes with him." GOD's Decree.
- 15 Her king will go into exile, he and his officials together," says the LORD.

Amos 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Moab --make that four--I'm not putting up with her any longer. She violated the corpse of Edom's king, burning it to cinders.
- 1 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Moab, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because he burned, as if to lime, the bones of Edom's king,
- 2 For that, I'm burning down Moab, burning down the forts of Kerioth. Moab will die in the shouting, go out in the blare of war trumpets.
- 2 I will send fire upon Moab that will consume the fortresses of Kerioth. Moab will go down in great tumult amid war cries and the blast of the trumpet.
- 3 I'll remove the king from the center and kill all his princes with him." GOD's Decree.
- 3 I will destroy her ruler and kill all her officials with him," says the LORD.
- 4 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Judah --make that four--I'm not putting up with them any longer. They rejected GOD's

revelation, refused to keep my commands. But they swallowed the same old lies that got their ancestors onto dead-end roads.

4 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Judah, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. Because they have rejected the law of the LORD and have not kept his decrees, because they have been led astray by false gods, the gods their ancestors followed,

5 For that, I'm burning down Judah, burning down all the forts of Jerusalem."

5 I will send fire upon Judah that will consume the fortresses of Jerusalem."

6 GOD's Message: "Because of the three great sins of Israel --make that four--I'm not putting up with them any longer. They buy and sell upstanding people. People for them are only things--ways of making money. They'd sell a poor man for a pair of shoes. They'd sell their own grandmother!

6 This is what the LORD says: "For three sins of Israel, even for four, I will not turn back my wrath. They sell the righteous for silver, and the needy for a pair of sandals.

7 They grind the penniless into the dirt, shove the luckless into the ditch. Everyone and his brother sleeps with the 'sacred whore'-- a sacrilege against my Holy Name.

7 They trample on the heads of the poor as upon the dust of the ground and deny justice to the oppressed. Father and son use the same girl and so profane my holy name.

8 Stuff they've extorted from the poor is piled up at the shrine of their god, While they sit around drinking wine they've conned from their victims.

8 They lie down beside every altar on garments taken in pledge. In the house of their god they drink wine taken as fines.

9 "In contrast, I was always on your side. I destroyed the Amorites who confronted you, Amorites with the stature of great cedars, tough as thick oaks. I destroyed them from the top branches down. I destroyed them from the roots up.

9 I destroyed the Amorite before them, though he was tall as the cedars and strong as the oaks. I destroyed his fruit above and his roots below.

10 And yes, I'm the One who delivered you from Egypt, led you safely through the wilderness for forty years And then handed you the country

- of the Amorites like a piece of cake on a platter.
- 10 I brought you up out of Egypt, and I led you forty years in the desert to give you the land of the Amorites.
- 11 I raised up some of your young men to be prophets, set aside your best youth for training in holiness. Isn't this so, Israel?" GOD's Decree.
- 11 I also raised up prophets from among your sons and Nazirites from among your young men. Is this not true, people of Israel?" declares the LORD.
- 12 "But you made the youth-in-training break training, and you told the young prophets, 'Don't prophesy!'
- 12 But you made the Nazirites drink wine and commanded the prophets not to prophesy.
- 13 You're too much for me. I'm hard-pressed--to the breaking point. I'm like a wagon piled high and overloaded, creaking and groaning.
- 13 Now then, I will crush you as a cart crushes when loaded with grain.
- 14 "When I go into action, what will you do? There's no place to run no matter how fast you run. The strength of the strong won't count. Fighters won't make it.
- 14 The swift will not escape, the strong will not muster their strength, and the warrior will not save his life.
- 15 Skilled archers won't make it. Fast runners won't make it. Chariot drivers won't make it.
- 15 The archer will not stand his ground, the fleet-footed soldier will not get away, and the horseman will not save his life.
- 16 Even the bravest of all your warriors Won't make it. He'll run off for dear life, stripped naked." GOD's Decree.
- 16 Even the bravest warriors will flee naked on that day," declares the LORD.

Amos 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen to this, Israel. GOD is calling you to account--and I mean all of you, everyone connected with the family that he delivered out of Egypt. Listen!

- 1 Hear this word the LORD has spoken against you, O people of Israel-- against the whole family I brought up out of Egypt:
- 2 "Out of all the families on earth, I picked you. Therefore, because of your special calling, I'm holding you responsible for all your sins."
- 2 You only have I chosen of all the families of the earth; therefore I will punish you for all your sins.
- 3 Do two people walk hand in hand if they aren't going to the same place?
- 3 Do two walk together unless they have agreed to do so?
- 4 Does a lion roar in the forest if there's no carcass to devour? Does a young lion growl with pleasure if he hasn't caught his supper?
- 4 Does a lion roar in the thicket when he has no prey? Does he growl in his den when he has caught nothing?
- 5 Does a bird fall to the ground if it hasn't been hit with a stone? Does a trap spring shut if nothing trips it?
- 5 Does a bird fall into a trap on the ground where no snare has been set? Does a trap spring up from the earth when there is nothing to catch?
- 6 When the alarm goes off in the city, aren't people alarmed? And when disaster strikes the city, doesn't GOD stand behind it?
- 6 When a trumpet sounds in a city, do not the people tremble? When disaster comes to a city, has not the LORD caused it?
- 7 The fact is, GOD, the Master, does nothing without first telling his prophets the whole story.
- 7 Surely the Sovereign LORD does nothing without revealing his plan to his servants the prophets.
- 8 The lion has roared-- who isn't frightened? GOD has spoken-- what prophet can keep quiet?
- 8 The lion has roared-- who will not fear? The Sovereign LORD has spoken-- who can but prophesy?
- 9 Announce to the forts of Assyria, announce to the forts of Egypt-- Tell them, "Gather on the Samaritan mountains, take a good, hard look: what a snake pit of brutality and terror!
- 9 Proclaim to the fortresses of Ashdod and to the fortresses of Egypt: "Assemble yourselves on the mountains of Samaria; see the great unrest within her and the oppression among her people."
- 10 They can't--or won't--do one thing right." GOD said so. "They stockpile violence and blight.

- 10 They do not know how to do right, declares the LORD, "who hoard plunder and loot in their fortresses."
- 11 Therefore"--this is GOD's Word--"an enemy will surround the country. He'll strip you of your power and plunder your forts."
- 11 Therefore this is what the Sovereign LORD says: "An enemy will overrun the land; he will pull down your strongholds and plunder your fortresses."
- 12 GOD's Message: "In the same way that a shepherd trying to save a lamb from a lion Manages to recover just a pair of legs or the scrap of an ear, So will little be saved of the Israelites who live in Samaria-- A couple of old chairs at most, the broken leg of a table.
- 12 This is what the LORD says: "As a shepherd saves from the lion's mouth only two leg bones or a piece of an ear, so will the Israelites be saved, those who sit in Samaria on the edge of their beds and in Damascus on their couches. "
- 13 "Listen and bring witness against Jacob's family"-- this is God's Word, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies!
- 13 Hear this and testify against the house of Jacob, declares the Lord, the LORD God Almighty.
- 14 "Note well! The day I make Israel pay for its sins, pay for the sin-altars of worship at Bethel, The horned altars will all be dehorned and scattered around.
- 14 On the day I punish Israel for her sins, I will destroy the altars of Bethel; the horns of the altar will be cut off and fall to the ground.
- 15 I'll tear down the winter palace, smash the summer palace--all your fancy buildings. The luxury homes will be demolished, all those pretentious houses." GOD's Decree.
- 15 I will tear down the winter house along with the summer house; the houses adorned with ivory will be destroyed and the mansions will be demolished," declares the LORD.

Amos 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 "Listen to this, you cows of Bashan grazing on the slopes of Samaria. You women! Mean to the poor, cruel to the down-and-out! Indolent and pampered, you demand of your husbands, 'Bring us a tall, cool drink!'"
- 1 Hear this word, you cows of Bashan on Mount Samaria, you women who oppress the poor and crush the needy and say to your husbands, "Bring us some drinks!"
- 2 "This is serious--I, GOD, have sworn by my holiness! Be well warned: Judgment Day is coming! They're going to rope you up and haul you off, keep the stragglers in line with cattle prods.
- 2 The Sovereign LORD has sworn by his holiness: "The time will surely come when you will be taken away with hooks, the last of you with fishhooks.
- 3 They'll drag you through the ruined city walls, forcing you out single file, And kick you to kingdom come." GOD's Decree.
- 3 You will each go straight out through breaks in the wall, and you will be cast out toward Harmon, " declares the LORD.
- 4 "Come along to Bethel and sin! And then to Gilgal and sin some more! Bring your sacrifices for morning worship. Every third day bring your tithe.
- 4 Go to Bethel and sin; go to Gilgal and sin yet more. Bring your sacrifices every morning, your tithes every three years.
- 5 Burn pure sacrifices--thank offerings. Speak up--announce freewill offerings! That's the sort of religious show you Israelites just love." GOD's Decree.
- 5 Burn leavened bread as a thank offering and brag about your freewill offerings-- boast about them, you Israelites, for this is what you love to do," declares the Sovereign LORD.
- 6 "You know, don't you, that I'm the One who emptied your pantries and cleaned out your cupboards, Who left you hungry and standing in bread lines? But you never got hungry for me. You continued to ignore me." GOD's Decree.
- 6 I gave you empty stomachs in every city and lack of bread in every town, yet you have not returned to me, declares the LORD.
- 7 "Yes, and I'm the One who stopped the rains three months short of harvest. I'd make it rain on one village but not on another. I'd make it rain on one field but not on another--and that one would dry up.

- 7 I also withheld rain from you when the harvest was still three months away. I sent rain on one town, but withheld it from another. One field had rain; another had none and dried up.
- 8 People would stagger from village to village crazed for water and never quenching their thirst. But you never got thirsty for me. You ignored me." GOD's Decree.
- 8 People staggered from town to town for water but did not get enough to drink, yet you have not returned to me," declares the LORD.
- 9 "I hit your crops with disease and withered your orchards and gardens. Locusts devoured your olive and fig trees, but you continued to ignore me." GOD's Decree.
- 9 Many times I struck your gardens and vineyards, I struck them with blight and mildew. Locusts devoured your fig and olive trees, yet you have not returned to me, declares the LORD.
- 10 "I revisited you with the old Egyptian plagues, killed your choice young men and prize horses. The stink of rot in your camps was so strong that you held your noses-- But you didn't notice me. You continued to ignore me." GOD's Decree.
- 10 I sent plagues among you as I did to Egypt. I killed your young men with the sword, along with your captured horses. I filled your nostrils with the stench of your camps, yet you have not returned to me, declares the LORD.
- 11 "I hit you with earthquake and fire, left you devastated like Sodom and Gomorrah. You were like a burning stick snatched from the flames. But you never looked my way. You continued to ignore me." GOD's Decree.
- 11 I overthrew some of you as I overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah. You were like a burning stick snatched from the fire, yet you have not returned to me, declares the LORD.
- 12 "All this I have done to you, Israel, and this is why I have done it. Time's up, O Israel! Prepare to meet your God!"
- 12 Therefore this is what I will do to you, Israel, and because I will do this to you, prepare to meet your God, O Israel.
- 13 Look who's here: Mountain-Shaper! Wind-Maker! He laid out the whole plot before Adam. He brings everything out of nothing, like dawn out of darkness. He strides across the alpine ridges. His name is GOD, God-of-the-Angel-Armies.

13 He who forms the mountains, creates the wind, and reveals his thoughts to man, he who turns dawn to darkness, and treads the high places of the earth-- the LORD God Almighty is his name.

Amos 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen to this, family of Israel, this Message I'm sending in bold print, this tragic warning:
- 1 Hear this word, O house of Israel, this lament I take up concerning you:
- 2 "Virgin Israel has fallen flat on her face. She'll never stand up again. She's been left where she's fallen. No one offers to help her up."
- 2 Fallen is Virgin Israel, never to rise again, deserted in her own land, with no one to lift her up.
- 3 This is the Message, GOD's Word: "The city that marches out with a thousand will end up with a hundred. The city that marches out with a hundred will end up with ten. Oh, family of Israel!"
- 3 This is what the Sovereign LORD says: "The city that marches out a thousand strong for Israel will have only a hundred left; the town that marches out a hundred strong will have only ten left."
- 4 GOD's Message to the family of Israel: "Seek me and live.
- 4 This is what the LORD says to the house of Israel: "Seek me and live;
- 5 Don't fool around at those shrines of Bethel, Don't waste time taking trips to Gilgal, and don't bother going down to Beer-sheba. Gilgal is here today and gone tomorrow and Bethel is all show, no substance."
- 5 do not seek Bethel, do not go to Gilgal, do not journey to Beersheba. For Gilgal will surely go into exile, and Bethel will be reduced to nothing. "
- 6 So seek GOD and live! You don't want to end up with nothing to show for your life But a pile of ashes, a house burned to the ground. For God will send just such a fire, and the firefighters will show up too late.
- 6 Seek the LORD and live, or he will sweep through the house of Joseph like a fire; it will devour, and Bethel will have no one to quench it.
- 7 Woe to you who turn justice to vinegar and stomp righteousness into the mud.
- 7 You who turn justice into bitterness and cast righteousness to the ground

- 8 Do you realize where you are? You're in a cosmos star-flung with constellations by God, A world God wakes up each morning and puts to bed each night. God dips water from the ocean and gives the land a drink. GOD, God-revealed, does all this.
- 8 (he who made the Pleiades and Orion, who turns blackness into dawn and darkens day into night, who calls for the waters of the sea and pours them out over the face of the land-- the LORD is his name--
- 9 And he can destroy it as easily as make it. He can turn this vast wonder into total waste.
- 9 he flashes destruction on the stronghold and brings the fortified city to ruin),
- 10 People hate this kind of talk. Raw truth is never popular.
- 10 you hate the one who reproves in court and despise him who tells the truth.
- 11 But here it is, bluntly spoken: Because you run roughshod over the poor and take the bread right out of their mouths, You're never going to move into the luxury homes you have built. You're never going to drink wine from the expensive vineyards you've planted.
- 11 You trample on the poor and force him to give you grain. Therefore, though you have built stone mansions, you will not live in them; though you have planted lush vineyards, you will not drink their wine.
- 12 I know precisely the extent of your violations, the enormity of your sins. Appalling! You bully right-living people, taking bribes right and left and kicking the poor when they're down.
- 12 For I know how many are your offenses and how great your sins. You oppress the righteous and take bribes and you deprive the poor of justice in the courts.
- 13 Justice is a lost cause. Evil is epidemic. Decent people throw up their hands. Protest and rebuke are useless, a waste of breath.
- 13 Therefore the prudent man keeps quiet in such times, for the times are evil.
- 14 Seek good and not evil-- and live! You talk about GOD, the God-of-the-Angel-Armies, being your best friend. Well, live like it, and maybe it will happen.
- 14 Seek good, not evil, that you may live. Then the LORD God Almighty will be with you, just as you say he is.

- 15 Hate evil and love good, then work it out in the public square. Maybe GOD, the God-of-the-Angel-Armies, will notice your remnant and be gracious.
- 15 Hate evil, love good; maintain justice in the courts. Perhaps the LORD God Almighty will have mercy on the remnant of Joseph.
- 16 Now again, my Master's Message, GOD, God-of-the-Angel-Armies: "Go out into the streets and lament loudly! Fill the malls and shops with cries of doom! Weep loudly, 'Not me! Not us, Not now!' Empty offices, stores, factories, workplaces. Enlist everyone in the general lament.
- 16 Therefore this is what the Lord, the LORD God Almighty, says: "There will be wailing in all the streets and cries of anguish in every public square. The farmers will be summoned to weep and the mourners to wail.
- 17 I want to hear it loud and clear when I make my visit." GOD's Decree.
- 17 There will be wailing in all the vineyards, for I will pass through your midst," says the LORD.
- 18 Woe to all of you who want GOD's Judgment Day! Why would you want to see GOD, want him to come? When GOD comes, it will be bad news before it's good news, the worst of times, not the best of times.
- 18 Woe to you who long for the day of the LORD! Why do you long for the day of the LORD? That day will be darkness, not light.
- 19 Here's what it's like: A man runs from a lion right into the jaws of a bear. A woman goes home after a hard day's work and is raped by a neighbor.
- 19 It will be as though a man fled from a lion only to meet a bear, as though he entered his house and rested his hand on the wall only to have a snake bite him.
- 20 At GOD's coming we face hard reality, not fantasy-- a black cloud with no silver lining.
- 20 Will not the day of the LORD be darkness, not light-- pitch-dark, without a ray of brightness?
- 21 "I can't stand your religious meetings. I'm fed up with your conferences and conventions.
- 21 I hate, I despise your religious feasts; I cannot stand your assemblies.
- 22 I want nothing to do with your religion projects, your pretentious slogans and goals. I'm sick of your fund-raising schemes, your public

- relations and image making.
- 22 Even though you bring me burnt offerings and grain offerings, I will not accept them. Though you bring choice fellowship offerings, I will have no regard for them.
- 23 I've had all I can take of your noisy ego-music. When was the last time you sang to me?
- 23 Away with the noise of your songs! I will not listen to the music of your harps.
- 24 Do you know what I want? I want justice--oceans of it. I want fairness--rivers of it. That's what I want. That's all I want.
- 24 But let justice roll on like a river, righteousness like a never-failing stream!
- 25 "Didn't you, dear family of Israel, worship me faithfully for forty years in the wilderness, bringing the sacrifices and offerings I commanded?
- 25 Did you bring me sacrifices and offerings forty years in the desert, O house of Israel?
- 26 How is it you've stooped to dragging gimcrack statues of your so-called rulers around, hauling the cheap images of all your star-gods here and there?
- 26 You have lifted up the shrine of your king, the pedestal of your idols, the star of your god-- which you made for yourselves.
- 27 Since you like them so much, you can take them with you when I drive you into exile beyond Damascus." GOD's Message, God-of-the-Angel-Armies.
- 27 Therefore I will send you into exile beyond Damascus," says the LORD, whose name is God Almighty.

Amos 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Woe to you who think you live on easy street in Zion, who think Mount Samaria is the good life. You assume you're at the top of the heap, voted the number-one best place to live.
- 1 Woe to you who are complacent in Zion, and to you who feel secure on Mount Samaria, you notable men of the foremost nation, to whom the

- people of Israel come!
- 2 Well, wake up and look around. Get off your pedestal. Take a look at Calneh. Go and visit Great Hamath. Look in on Gath of the Philistines. Doesn't that take you off your high horse? Compared to them, you're not much, are you?
 - 2 Go to Calneh and look at it; go from there to great Hamath, and then go down to Gath in Philistia. Are they better off than your two kingdoms? Is their land larger than yours?
 - 3 Woe to you who are rushing headlong to disaster! Catastrophe is just around the corner!
 - 3 You put off the evil day and bring near a reign of terror.
 - 4 Woe to those who live in luxury and expect everyone else to serve them!
 - 4 You lie on beds inlaid with ivory and lounge on your couches. You dine on choice lambs and fattened calves.
 - 5 Woe to those who live only for today, indifferent to the fate of others! Woe to the playboys, the playgirls, who think life is a party held just for them!
 - 5 You strum away on your harps like David and improvise on musical instruments.
 - 6 Woe to those addicted to feeling good--life without pain! those obsessed with looking good--life without wrinkles! They could not care less about their country going to ruin.
 - 6 You drink wine by the bowlful and use the finest lotions, but you do not grieve over the ruin of Joseph.
 - 7 But here's what's really coming: a forced march into exile. They'll leave the country whining, a rag-tag bunch of good-for-nothings.
 - 7 Therefore you will be among the first to go into exile; your feasting and lounging will end.
 - 8 GOD, the Master, has sworn, and solemnly stands by his Word. The God-of-the-Angel-Armies speaks: "I hate the arrogance of Jacob. I have nothing but contempt for his forts. I'm about to hand over the city and everyone in it."
 - 8 The Sovereign LORD has sworn by himself--the LORD God Almighty declares: "I abhor the pride of Jacob and detest his fortresses; I will deliver up the city and everything in it."
 - 9 Ten men are in a house, all dead.

- 9 If ten men are left in one house, they too will die.
- 10 A relative comes and gets the bodies to prepare them for a decent burial. He discovers a survivor huddled in a closet and asks, "Are there any more?" The answer: "Not a soul. But hush! GOD must not be mentioned in this desecrated place."
- 10 And if a relative who is to burn the bodies comes to carry them out of the house and asks anyone still hiding there, "Is anyone with you?" and he says, "No," then he will say, "Hush! We must not mention the name of the LORD."
- 11 Note well: GOD issues the orders. He'll knock large houses to smithereens. He'll smash little houses to bits.
- 11 For the LORD has given the command, and he will smash the great house into pieces and the small house into bits.
- 12 Do you hold a horse race in a field of rocks? Do you plow the sea with oxen? You'd cripple the horses and drown the oxen. And yet you've made a shambles of justice, a bloated corpse of righteousness,
- 12 Do horses run on the rocky crags? Does one plow there with oxen? But you have turned justice into poison and the fruit of righteousness into bitterness--
- 13 Bragging of your trivial pursuits, beating up on the weak and crowing, "Look what I've done!"
- 13 you who rejoice in the conquest of Lo Debar and say, "Did we not take Karnaim by our own strength?"
- 14 "Enjoy it while you can, you Israelites. I've got a pagan army on the move against you" --this is your GOD speaking, God-of-the-Angel-Armies-- "And they'll make hash of you, from one end of the country to the other."
- 14 For the LORD God Almighty declares, "I will stir up a nation against you, O house of Israel, that will oppress you all the way from Lebo Hamath to the valley of the Arabah."

Amos 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD, my Master, showed me this vision: He was preparing a locust swarm. The first cutting, which went to the king, was complete, and the second crop was just sprouting.
- 1 This is what the Sovereign LORD showed me: He was preparing swarms of locusts after the king's share had been harvested and just as the second crop was coming up.
- 2 The locusts ate everything green. Not even a blade of grass was left. I called out, "GOD, my Master! Excuse me, but what's going to come of Jacob? He's so small."
- 2 When they had stripped the land clean, I cried out, "Sovereign LORD, forgive! How can Jacob survive? He is so small!"
- 3 GOD gave in. "It won't happen," he said.
- 3 So the LORD relented. "This will not happen," the LORD said.
- 4 GOD showed me this vision: Oh! GOD, my Master GOD was calling up a firestorm. It burned up the ocean. Then it burned up the Promised Land.
- 4 This is what the Sovereign LORD showed me: The Sovereign LORD was calling for judgment by fire; it dried up the great deep and devoured the land.
- 5 I said, "God, my Master! Hold it--please! What's going to come of Jacob? He's so small."
- 5 Then I cried out, "Sovereign LORD, I beg you, stop! How can Jacob survive? He is so small!"
- 6 GOD gave in. "All right, this won't happen either," GOD, my Master, said.
- 6 So the LORD relented. "This will not happen either," the Sovereign LORD said.
- 7 GOD showed me this vision: My Master was standing beside a wall. In his hand he held a plumb line.
- 7 This is what he showed me: The Lord was standing by a wall that had been built true to plumb, with a plumb line in his hand.
- 8 GOD said to me, "What do you see, Amos?" I said, "A plumb line." Then my Master said, "Look what I've done. I've hung a plumb line in the midst of my people Israel. I've spared them for the last time. This is it!"
- 8 And the LORD asked me, "What do you see, Amos?" "A plumb line," I replied. Then the Lord said, "Look, I am setting a plumb line among my

- people Israel; I will spare them no longer.
- 9 Isaac's sex-and-religion shrines will be smashed, Israel's unholy shrines will be knocked to pieces. I'm raising my sword against the royal family of Jeroboam.
- 9 The high places of Isaac will be destroyed and the sanctuaries of Israel will be ruined; with my sword I will rise against the house of Jeroboam.
- 10 Amaziah, priest at the shrine at Bethel, sent a message to Jeroboam, king of Israel: "Amos is plotting to get rid of you; and he's doing it as an insider, working from within Israel. His talk will destroy the country. He's got to be silenced. Do you know what Amos is saying?"
- 10 Then Amaziah the priest of Bethel sent a message to Jeroboam king of Israel: "Amos is raising a conspiracy against you in the very heart of Israel. The land cannot bear all his words.
- 11 Jeroboam will be killed. Israel is headed for exile."
- 11 For this is what Amos is saying: " 'Jeroboam will die by the sword, and Israel will surely go into exile, away from their native land.' "
- 12 Then Amaziah confronted Amos: "Seer, be on your way! Get out of here and go back to Judah where you came from!
- 12 Then Amaziah said to Amos, "Get out, you seer! Go back to the land of Judah. Earn your bread there and do your prophesying there.
- 13 Hang out there. Do your preaching there. But no more preaching at Bethel! Don't show your face here again. This is the king's chapel. This is a royal shrine."
- 13 Don't prophesy anymore at Bethel, because this is the king's sanctuary and the temple of the kingdom."
- 14 But Amos stood up to Amaziah: "I never set up to be a preacher, never had plans to be a preacher. I raised cattle and I pruned trees.
- 14 Amos answered Amaziah, "I was neither a prophet nor a prophet's son, but I was a shepherd, and I also took care of sycamore- fig trees.
- 15 Then GOD took me off the farm and said, 'Go preach to my people Israel.'
- 15 But the LORD took me from tending the flock and said to me, 'Go, prophesy to my people Israel.'
- 16 "So listen to GOD's Word. You tell me, 'Don't preach to Israel. Don't say anything against the family of Isaac.'

- 16 Now then, hear the word of the LORD. You say, " 'Do not prophesy against Israel, and stop preaching against the house of Isaac.'
- 17 But here's what GOD is telling you: Your wife will become a whore in town. Your children will get killed. Your land will be auctioned off. You will die homeless and friendless. And Israel will be hauled off to exile, far from home."
- 17 Therefore this is what the LORD says: 'Your wife will become a prostitute in the city, and your sons and daughters will fall by the sword. Your land will be measured and divided up, and you yourself will die in a pagan country. And Israel will certainly go into exile, away from their native land.' "

Amos 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 My Master GOD showed me this vision: A bowl of fresh fruit.
- 1 This is what the Sovereign LORD showed me: a basket of ripe fruit.
- 2 He said, "What do you see, Amos?" I said, "A bowl of fresh, ripe fruit." GOD said, "Right. So, I'm calling it quits with my people Israel. I'm no longer acting as if everything is just fine."
- 2 What do you see, Amos? he asked. "A basket of ripe fruit," I answered. Then the LORD said to me, "The time is ripe for my people Israel; I will spare them no longer.
- 3 "The royal singers will wail when it happens." My Master GOD said so. "Corpses will be strewn here, there, and everywhere. Hush!"
- 3 In that day, declares the Sovereign LORD, "the songs in the temple will turn to wailing. Many, many bodies--flung everywhere! Silence!"
- 4 Listen to this, you who walk all over the weak, you who treat poor people as less than nothing,
- 4 Hear this, you who trample the needy and do away with the poor of the land,
- 5 Who say, "When's my next paycheck coming so I can go out and live it up? How long till the weekend when I can go out and have a good time?" Who give little and take much, and never do an honest day's work.

- 5 saying, "When will the New Moon be over that we may sell grain, and the Sabbath be ended that we may market wheat?"-- skimping the measure, boosting the price and cheating with dishonest scales,
- 6 You exploit the poor, using them-- and then, when they're used up, you discard them.
- 6 buying the poor with silver and the needy for a pair of sandals, selling even the sweepings with the wheat.
- 7 GOD swears against the arrogance of Jacob: "I'm keeping track of their every last sin."
- 7 The LORD has sworn by the Pride of Jacob: "I will never forget anything they have done.
- 8 God's oath will shake earth's foundations, dissolve the whole world into tears. God's oath will sweep in like a river that rises, flooding houses and lands, And then recedes, leaving behind a sea of mud.
- 8 Will not the land tremble for this, and all who live in it mourn? The whole land will rise like the Nile; it will be stirred up and then sink like the river of Egypt.
- 9 "On Judgment Day, watch out!" These are the words of GOD, my Master. "I'll turn off the sun at noon. In the middle of the day the earth will go black.
- 9 In that day, declares the Sovereign LORD, "I will make the sun go down at noon and darken the earth in broad daylight.
- 10 I'll turn your parties into funerals and make every song you sing a dirge. Everyone will walk around in rags, with sunken eyes and bald heads. Think of the worst that could happen --your only son, say, murdered. That's a hint of Judgment Day --that and much more.
- 10 I will turn your religious feasts into mourning and all your singing into weeping. I will make all of you wear sackcloth and shave your heads. I will make that time like mourning for an only son and the end of it like a bitter day.
- 11 "Oh yes, Judgment Day is coming!" These are the words of my Master GOD. "I'll send a famine through the whole country. It won't be food or water that's lacking, but my Word.
- 11 The days are coming, declares the Sovereign LORD, "when I will send a famine through the land-- not a famine of food or a thirst for water, but a famine of hearing the words of the LORD.

- 12 People will drift from one end of the country to the other, roam to the north, wander to the east. They'll go anywhere, listen to anyone, hoping to hear GOD's Word--but they won't hear it.
- 12 Men will stagger from sea to sea and wander from north to east, searching for the word of the LORD, but they will not find it.
- 13 "On Judgment Day, lovely young girls will faint of Word-thirst, robust young men will faint of God-thirst,
- 13 In that day the lovely young women and strong young men will faint because of thirst.
- 14 Along with those who take oaths at the Samaria Sin-and-Sex Center, saying, 'As the lord god of Dan is my witness!' and 'The lady goddess of Beer-sheba bless you!' Their lives will fall to pieces. They'll never put it together again."
- 14 They who swear by the shame of Samaria, or say, 'As surely as your god lives, O Dan,' or, 'As surely as the god of Beersheba lives'-- they will fall, never to rise again."

Amos 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 I saw my Master standing beside the altar at the shrine. He said: "Hit the tops of the shrine's pillars, make the floor shake. The roof's about to fall on the heads of the people, and whoever's still alive, I'll kill. No one will get away, no runaways will make it.
- 1 I saw the Lord standing by the altar, and he said: "Strike the tops of the pillars so that the thresholds shake. Bring them down on the heads of all the people; those who are left I will kill with the sword. Not one will get away, none will escape.
- 2 If they dig their way down into the underworld, I'll find them and bring them up. If they climb to the stars, I'll find them and bring them down.
- 2 Though they dig down to the depths of the grave, from there my hand will take them. Though they climb up to the heavens, from there I will bring them down.
- 3 If they hide out at the top of Mount Carmel, I'll find them and bring them back. If they dive to the bottom of the ocean, I'll send Dragon to swallow

them up.

- 3 Though they hide themselves on the top of Carmel, there I will hunt them down and seize them. Though they hide from me at the bottom of the sea, there I will command the serpent to bite them.
- 4 If they're captured alive by their enemies, I'll send Sword to kill them. I've made up my mind to hurt them, not help them."
- 4 Though they are driven into exile by their enemies, there I will command the sword to slay them. I will fix my eyes upon them for evil and not for good."
- 5 My Master, GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies, touches the earth, a mere touch, and it trembles. The whole world goes into mourning. Earth swells like the Nile at flood stage; then the water subsides, like the great Nile of Egypt.
- 5 The Lord, the LORD Almighty, he who touches the earth and it melts, and all who live in it mourn-- the whole land rises like the Nile, then sinks like the river of Egypt--
- 6 God builds his palace--towers soaring high in the skies, foundations set on the rock-firm earth. He calls ocean waters and they come, then he ladles them out on the earth. GOD, your God, does all this.
- 6 he who builds his lofty palace in the heavens and sets its foundation on the earth, who calls for the waters of the sea and pours them out over the face of the land-- the LORD is his name.
- 7 "Do you Israelites think you're any better than the far-off Cushites?" GOD's Decree. "Am I not involved with all nations? Didn't I bring Israel up from Egypt, the Philistines from Caphtor, the Arameans from Qir?"
- 7 Are not you Israelites the same to me as the Cushites? declares the LORD. "Did I not bring Israel up from Egypt, the Philistines from Caphtor and the Arameans from Kir?"
- 8 But you can be sure that I, GOD, the Master, have my eye on the Kingdom of Sin. I'm going to wipe it off the face of the earth. Still, I won't totally destroy the family of Jacob." GOD's Decree.
- 8 Surely the eyes of the Sovereign LORD are on the sinful kingdom. I will destroy it from the face of the earth-- yet I will not totally destroy the house of Jacob, declares the LORD.
- 9 "I'm still giving the orders around here. I'm throwing Israel into a sieve among all the nations and shaking them good, shaking out all the sin, all

- the sinners. No real grain will be lost,
- 9 For I will give the command, and I will shake the house of Israel among all the nations as grain is shaken in a sieve, and not a pebble will reach the ground.
- 10 but all the sinners will be sifted out and thrown away, the people who say, 'Nothing bad will ever happen in our lifetime. It won't even come close.'
- 10 All the sinners among my people will die by the sword, all those who say, 'Disaster will not overtake or meet us.'
- 11 "But also on that Judgment Day I will restore David's house that has fallen to pieces. I'll repair the holes in the roof, replace the broken windows, fix it up like new. David's people will be strong again
- 11 In that day I will restore David's fallen tent. I will repair its broken places, restore its ruins, and build it as it used to be,
- 12 and seize what's left of enemy Edom, plus everyone else under my sovereign judgment." GOD's Decree. He will do this.
- 12 so that they may possess the remnant of Edom and all the nations that bear my name, " declares the LORD, who will do these things.
- 13 "Yes indeed, it won't be long now." GOD's Decree. "Things are going to happen so fast your head will swim, one thing fast on the heels of the other. You won't be able to keep up. Everything will be happening at once--and everywhere you look, blessings! Blessings like wine pouring off the mountains and hills.
- 13 The days are coming, declares the LORD, "when the reaper will be overtaken by the plowman and the planter by the one treading grapes. New wine will drip from the mountains and flow from all the hills.
- 14 I'll make everything right again for my people Israel: "They'll rebuild their ruined cities. They'll plant vineyards and drink good wine. They'll work their gardens and eat fresh vegetables.
- 14 I will bring back my exiled people Israel; they will rebuild the ruined cities and live in them. They will plant vineyards and drink their wine; they will make gardens and eat their fruit.
- 15 And I'll plant them, plant them on their own land. They'll never again be uprooted from the land I've given them." GOD, your God, says so.
- 15 I will plant Israel in their own land, never again to be uprooted from the land I have given them," says the LORD your God.

